

MAC'S HIDDEN FEATURES AND HACKS

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I bought my first Mac about 10 years ago, and it can still manage to surprise me with what I can do with the machine and the operating system (OS). Mac comes with several hidden features that are not only super cool but also save me a ton of time and effort. Although a bit on a higher end price wise, I personally find it worth every penny.

The popular saying, “Once you go Mac, you cannot go back!” truly resonates with me. In this article we tell you about some useful features that have been introduced to Mac operating system over the years.

Do unit conversions in Spotlight

As you all know, Spotlight is capable of basic calculations, but in High Sierra (latest version of Mac OS) it can help you with unit conversions. It can do specific unit conversions if that is what you want—say, 10 pounds to kilograms—but it is intelligent enough to suggest not just the likely

conversion but also many alternates when you type in the amount and unit you want to convert.

For example, type in ‘\$1500’ and you will be shown what that is in Indian Rupees (based presumably on what is set as your native currency in Language & Region in System Preferences). And when the window folds down to show more results, you will see results in Yen, Euros, Sterling Pounds and so on.

Rename batches of files at once

Say, you have a folder containing almost 1000 photographs from a trip you recently took, and you need to rename these. This can be an extremely tedious and irritating task. Yosemite onwards, you can rename files with one simple action.

Select all files you want to rename and right-click. Choose Rename X Items option. This will give you three options for renaming: Replace Text, Add Text

and Format. Replace Text option allows you to change full or part of the file name. For example, ‘IMG’ part of the file name can be changed to something more specific. So, ‘IMG_01,’ ‘IMG_02’ and so on can be changed to ‘Trip to Turkey_01,’ and ‘Trip to Turkey_02’ and so on.

Run Windows on Apple

If you are someone who just cannot survive without your Windows machine, simply run a copy of Windows on your Mac. To do so, Navigate to Applications folder on your Mac, followed by Utilities folder. In there, there is a program known as Boot Camp, which allows you to create a partition on the hard drive—essentially, split it between Windows and Mac. You can choose in what ratio you want to split the hard drive, but remember that storage allocated to one operating system is not accessible by the other.

Click Partition to start the process. Restart your Mac. It will ask for a Win-

